

UNIT 3

Brave New World

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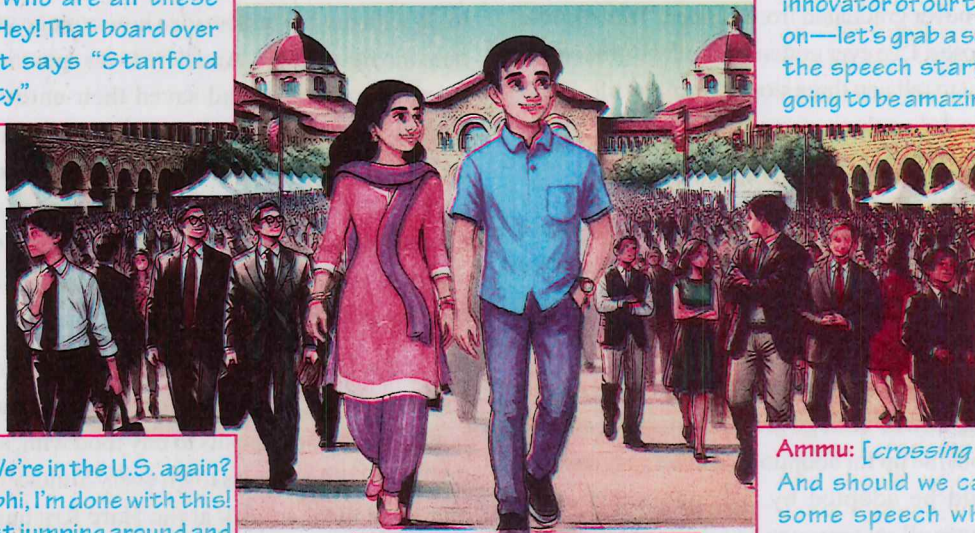
Ammu and Abhi bid farewell to O. Henry after wishing Jimmy Valentine and Annabel. They get into the time machine, and try their luck one more time

1

Abhi: Where are we now, Ammu? Who are all these people? Hey! That board over there. It says "Stanford University."

5

Abhi: Ammu, we can't miss it! He is the greatest innovator of our time! Come on—let's grab a seat before the speech starts. This is going to be amazing!



2

Ammu: We're in the U.S. again? Oh no! Abhi, I'm done with this! We're just jumping around and never getting home.

4

Ammu: [crossing her arms] And should we care about some speech when we're stuck here and not home? Is it that important?

Abhi: [points to a banner nearby] Wait, look! Did you see that? "Steve Jobs: Commencement Speech, 2005." Ammu, he's the man behind the iPhone!

3

They walk into the hall—Ammu still muttering—but a spark of curiosity flickers in her eyes as Abhi's excitement pulls her along.

You've Got to Find What You Love

Steve Jobs

The Lesson

I am honored to be with you today at your commencement from one of the finest universities in the world. I never graduated from college. Truth be told, this is the closest I've ever gotten to a college graduation. Today I want to tell you three stories from my life. That's it. No big deal. Just three stories.

The first story is about connecting the dots.

I dropped out of Reed College after the first 6 months, but then stayed around as a drop-in for another 18 months or so before I really quit. So why did I drop out?

It started before I was born. My biological mother was a young, unwed college graduate student, and she decided to put me up for adoption. She felt very strongly that I should be adopted by college graduates, so everything was all set for me to be adopted at birth by a lawyer and his wife. Except that when I popped out, they decided at the last minute that they really wanted a girl. So my parents, who were on a waiting list, got a call in the middle of the night asking: "We have an unexpected baby boy; do you want him?" They said: "Of course." My biological mother later found out that my mother had never graduated from college and that my father had never graduated from high school. She refused to sign the final adoption papers. She only relented a few months later when my parents promised that I would someday go to college.

And 17 years later I did go to college. But I naively chose a college that was almost as expensive as Stanford, and all of my working-class parents' savings

were being spent on my college tuition. After six months, I couldn't see the value in it. I had no idea what I wanted to do with my life and no idea how college was going to help me figure it out. And here I was spending all of the money my parents had saved their entire life. So, I decided to drop out and trust that it would all work out OK. It was pretty scary at the time, but looking back it was one of the best decisions I ever made. The minute I dropped out I could stop taking the required classes that didn't interest me, and begin dropping in on the ones that looked interesting.

It wasn't all romantic. I didn't have a dorm room so I slept on the floor in friends' rooms, I returned Coke bottles for the 5¢ deposits to buy food with, and I would walk the 7 miles across town every Sunday night to get one good meal a week at the Hare Krishna temple. I loved it. And much of what I stumbled into by following my curiosity and intuition turned out to be priceless later on. Let me give you one example:

Reed College at that time offered perhaps the best calligraphy instruction in the country. Throughout the campus every poster, every label on every drawer, was beautifully hand calligraphed. Because I had dropped out and didn't have to take the normal classes,

Pause and Ponder

Abhi: Wow! It really takes a lot of hard work and perseverance to achieve greatness.

Ammu: Yes! We should never give up. We should always be patient and find ways to achieve our goals.

I decided to take a calligraphy class to learn how to do this. I learned about serif and sans serif typefaces, about varying the amount of space between different letter combinations, about what makes great typography great. It was beautiful, historical, artistically subtle in a way that science can't capture, and I found it fascinating.

None of this had even a hope of any practical application in my life. But 10 years later, when we were designing the first Macintosh computer, it all came back to me. And we designed it all into the Mac. It was the first computer with beautiful typography. If I had never dropped in on that single course in college, the Mac would have never had multiple typefaces or proportionally spaced fonts. And since Windows just copied the Mac, it's likely that no personal computer would have them. If I had never dropped out, I would have never dropped in on this calligraphy class, and personal computers might not have the wonderful typography that they do. Of course, it was impossible to connect the dots looking forward when I was in college. But it was very, very clear looking backward 10 years later.

Again, you can't connect the dots looking forward; you can only connect them looking backward. So, you have to trust that the dots will somehow connect in your future. You have to trust in something — your gut, destiny, life, karma, whatever. This approach has never let me down, and it has made all the difference in my life.

My second story is about love and loss.

I was lucky — I found what I loved to do early in life. Woz and I started Apple in my parents' garage when I was 20. We worked hard, and in 10 years Apple had grown from just the two of us in a garage into a \$2 billion company with over 4,000 employees. We had just released our finest creation — the Macintosh — a year earlier, and I had just turned 30. And then I got fired. How can you get fired from a company you started? Well, as Apple grew, we hired someone who I thought

was very talented to run the company with me, and for the first year or so things went well. But then our visions of the future began to diverge and eventually we had a falling out. When we did, our Board of Directors sided with him. So, at 30 I was out. And very publicly out. What had been the focus of my entire adult life was gone, and it was devastating.

I really didn't know what to do for a few months. I felt that I had let the previous generation of entrepreneurs down — that I had dropped the baton as it was being passed to me. I met with David Packard and Bob Noyce and tried to apologize for screwing up so badly. I was a very public failure, and I even thought about running away from the valley. But something slowly began to dawn on me — I still loved what I did. The turn of events at Apple had not changed that one bit. I had been rejected, but I was still in love. And so, I decided to start over.

I didn't see it then, but it turned out that getting fired from Apple was the best thing that could have ever happened to me. The heaviness of being successful was replaced by the lightness of being a beginner again, less sure about everything. It freed me to enter one of the most creative periods of my life.

During the next five years, I started a company named NeXT, another company named Pixar, and fell in love with an amazing woman who would become my wife. Pixar went on to create the world's first computer animated feature film, Toy Story, and is now the most

Pause and Ponder

Abhi: Wow! Steve Jobs turned a failure into success!

Ammu: Yes! That is why we should believe in what we can do!

successful animation studio in the world. In a remarkable turn of events, Apple bought NeXT, I returned to Apple, and the technology we developed at NeXT is at the heart of Apple's current renaissance. And Laurene and I have a wonderful family together.

I'm pretty sure none of this would have happened if I hadn't been fired from Apple. It was awful tasting medicine, but I guess the patient needed it. Sometimes life hits you in the head with a brick. Don't lose faith. I'm convinced that the only thing that kept me going was that I loved what I did. You've got to find what you love. And that is as true for your work as it is for your lovers. Your work is going to fill a large part of your life, and the only way to be truly satisfied is to do what you believe is great work. And the only way to do great work is to love what you do. If you haven't found it yet, keep looking. Don't settle. As with all matters of the heart, you'll know when you find it. And, like any great relationship, it just gets better and better as the years roll on. So keep looking until you find it. Don't settle.

My third story is about death.

When I was 17, I read a quote that went something like: "If you live each day as if it was your last, someday you'll most certainly be right." It made an impression on me, and since then, for the past 33 years, I have looked in the mirror every morning and asked myself: "If today were the last day of my life, would I want to do what I am about to do today?" And whenever the answer has been "No" for too many days in a row, I know I need to change something.

Remembering that I'll be dead soon is the most important tool I've ever encountered to help me make the big choices in life. Because almost everything — all external expectations, all pride, all fear of embarrassment or failure — these things just fall away in the face of death, leaving only what is truly important. Remembering

that you are going to die is the best way I know to avoid the trap of thinking you have something to lose. You are already naked. There is no reason not to follow your heart.

About a year ago I was diagnosed with cancer. I had a scan at 7:30 in the morning, and it clearly showed a tumor on my pancreas. I didn't even know what a pancreas was. The doctors told me this was almost certainly a type of cancer that is incurable, and that I should expect to live no longer than three to six months. My doctor advised me to go home and get my affairs in order, which is doctor's code for prepare to die. It means to try to tell your kids everything you thought you'd have the next 10 years to tell them in just a few months. It means to make sure everything is buttoned up so that it will be as easy as possible for your family. It means to say your goodbyes.

I lived with that diagnosis all day. Later that evening I had a biopsy, where they stuck an endoscope down my throat, through my stomach and into my intestines, put a needle into my pancreas and got a few cells from the tumor. I was sedated, but my wife, who was there, told me that when they viewed the cells under a microscope the doctors started crying because it turned out to be a very rare form of pancreatic cancer that is curable with surgery. I had the surgery and I'm fine now.

This was the closest I've been to facing death, and I hope it's the closest I get for a few more decades. Having lived through it, I can now say this to you with a bit more certainty than when death was a useful but purely intellectual concept:

Pause and Ponder

Abhi: Ammu, we also shouldn't waste our time. It is really precious!

Ammu: Yes, Abhi! We should stay focused on our goals every single day!

No one wants to die. Even people who want to go to heaven don't want to die to get there. And yet death is the destination we all share. No one has ever escaped it. And that is as it should be, because Death is very likely the single best invention of Life. It is Life's change agent. It clears out the old to make way for the new. Right now, the new is you, but someday not too long from now, you will gradually become the old and be cleared away. Sorry to be so dramatic, but it is quite true.

Your time is limited, so don't waste it living someone else's life. Don't be trapped by dogma—which is living with the results of other people's thinking. Don't let the noise of others' opinions drown out your own inner voice. And most important, have the courage to follow your heart and intuition. They somehow already know what you truly want to become. Everything else is secondary.

When I was young, there was an amazing publication called *The Whole Earth Catalog*, which was one of the bibles of my generation. It was created by a

fellow named Stewart Brand not far from here in Menlo Park, and he brought it to life with his poetic touch. This was in the late 1960s, before personal computers and desktop publishing, so it was all made with typewriters, scissors and Polaroid cameras. It was sort of like Google in paperback form, 35 years before Google came along: It was idealistic, and overflowing with neat tools and great notions.

Stewart and his team put out several issues of *The Whole Earth Catalog*, and then when it had run its course, they put out a final issue. It was the mid-1970s, and I was your age. On the back cover of their final issue was a photograph of an early morning country road, the kind you might find yourself hitchhiking on if you were so adventurous. Beneath it were the words: "Stay Hungry. Stay Foolish." It was their farewell message as they signed off. Stay Hungry. Stay Foolish. And I have always wished that for myself. And now, as you graduate to begin anew, I wish that for you.

Stay Hungry. Stay Foolish.

Thank you all very much.

Theme Shopping for Students

Below are the key themes and objectives to learn from Steve Jobs' "You've Got to Find What you Love". As you understand each one, mark it off.

- ☐ Can you reflect on what it means to truly love what you do and why it matters?
- ☐ Have you thought about how passion and perseverance can help overcome challenges?
- ☐ Can you identify examples of people who turned their passion into a career or significant achievement?
- ☐ Have you considered the role of failure and how it can lead to learning and success?
- ☐ Are you prepared to explore what inspires you and think about your own dreams?

About the Speaker

Steve Jobs (1955–2011) was a visionary entrepreneur, innovator, and co-founder of Apple Inc. Renowned for revolutionizing the technology industry, Jobs introduced groundbreaking products like the Macintosh computer, iPhone, and iPad. His influence extended to animation through Pixar, producing Oscar winning hits like Toy Story. Known for his creativity and resilience, Jobs overcame personal and professional challenges, leaving a legacy of innovation and inspiration. His iconic 2005 Stanford commencement speech “You’ve Got to Find What You Love,” reflects his philosophy of passion, perseverance, and following one’s heart.



The Summary

Steve Jobs delivered his iconic commencement speech, “You’ve Got to Find What You Love” at Stanford University on June 12, 2005. In this inspiring address, Jobs shares pivotal moments from his life, including his decision to drop out of college, his experiences with failure, and his journey to success. He shares valuable life lessons for the graduates through three impactful stories from his life, each conveying important life lessons.

The first story is about “connecting the dots.” He explains that dropping out of college allowed him to follow his curiosity, leading him to a calligraphy class that later influenced the design of the first Macintosh computer’s typography interfaces. He emphasizes that while it’s hard to see how events connect looking forward, they make sense looking back.

The second story is about “love and loss.” Steve Jobs recounts being fired from Apple, the company he co-founded, which initially felt devastating but eventually led to a period of immense creativity. He started two successful companies, NeXT and Pixar, and later returned to Apple. This experience taught him the importance of loving what you do, as passion can drive success even in the face of setbacks.

The third story focuses on “death.” After a cancer diagnosis, Steve Jobs reflected on the importance of living each day as if it were the last. He stresses that remembering the inevitability of death helps clarify what truly matters in life. His advice to the audience is to follow their hearts, trust their intuition, and not to be afraid to take risks.

The speech concludes with Steve Jobs’ wish for the audience to “Stay Hungry. Stay Foolish,” encouraging them to continually seek new opportunities and remain curious and adventurous.

Glossary

- **Awful** /'ɔ:fl/ (**adjective**): Extremely bad or unpleasant
Usage: The food tasted awful, but I had to eat it to be polite.
- **Baton** /'bætn/ (**noun**): A thin stick used by a conductor to direct an orchestra or by relay runners during a race. Here, it symbolizes responsibility, legacy, or leadership being handed down from one generation to the next.
Usage: After years of leadership, he felt it was time to hand over the baton to someone with fresh ideas.
- **Calligraphy** /kə'liɡrəfi/ (**noun**): Decorative handwriting or handwritten lettering
Usage: She learned calligraphy to improve her artistic skills.
- **Destiny** /'destɪni/ (**noun**): The events that will necessarily happen to a person in the future; fate
Usage: He believed it was his destiny to become an artist.
- **Devastating** /'devəstɜ:tɪŋ/ (**adjective**): Highly destructive or damaging; causing extreme distress
Usage: The Hud Hud cyclone had a devastating impact on Visakhapatnam city.
- **Diagnosis** /daɪəg'nəʊsɪs/ (**noun**): The identification of the nature of an illness or problem through examination
Usage: Early diagnosis can save lives.
- **Diverge** /dar'vɜ:dʒ/ (**verb**): To separate from another route, especially a main one, and go in a different direction
Usage: Their opinions began to diverge over time.
- **Dogma** /'dɒgmə/ (**noun**): A set of principles laid down by an authority as incontrovertibly true
Usage: The book challenges traditional dogma.
- **Dorm room** /dɔ:m ru:m/ (**noun**): A room in a dormitory where students live and sleep
Usage: The dorm room was small but convenient.
- **Embarrassment** /ɪm'bærəsmənt/ (**noun**): A feeling of self-consciousness, shame, or awkwardness
Usage: He flushed with embarrassment after forgetting his lines.
- **Endoscope** /'endəskəʊp/ (**noun**): An instrument used to examine the interior of a body organ
Usage: The surgeon used an endoscope for the procedure.
- **Entrepreneurs** /ɒntrəprə'nɜ:z/ (**noun**): People who organise and operate businesses, taking financial risks
Usage: Entrepreneurs play a key role in the economy.
- **Fascinating** /'fæsnertɪŋ/ (**adjective**): Extremely interesting or captivating
Usage: The book provides a fascinating insight into history.
- **Fonts** /fɒnts/ (**noun**): Styles or designs of text characters in printing or digital documents
Usage: She experimented with different fonts for the poster.
- **Got fired** /ɡɒt 'faɪəd/ (**Phrasal Verb**): To lose one's job due to being dismissed
Usage: He got fired for consistently arriving late.
- **Intuition** /ɪntju'ɪʃən/ (**noun**): The ability to understand something instinctively without conscious reasoning
Usage: Her intuition told her something was wrong.
- **Naively** /naɪ'i:vli/ (**adverb**): In a way that shows a lack of experience, wisdom, or judgment
Usage: She naively believed every word he said.

- **Poetic touch** /pəʊ'etɪk tʌtʃ/ (**noun**): A quality of beauty or artistic sensitivity in writing or expression
Usage: Her speech had a poetic touch that captivated the audience.
- **Relent** /rɪ'lent/ (**verb**): To become less severe or give in after resistance
Usage: After hours of negotiation, he finally relented.
- **Renaissance** /rɪ'neɪsəns/ or /'renəsɑːns/ (**noun**): A revival or renewed interest in something; also refers to the European cultural movement from the 14th to the 17th century
Usage: The city experienced a renaissance in arts and culture.
- **Scary** /'skeəri/ (**adjective**): Causing fear or fright
Usage: The movie was so scary I couldn't sleep.
- **Sedated** /sɪ'detɪd/ (**adjective**): Under the influence of a sedative, calm, or tranquilized
Usage: The patient was sedated before the operation.
- **Stumble** /'stʌmbl/ (**verb**): (Here) To come across or encounter something by chance, often unexpectedly (or) To trip or lose balance momentarily; also to falter in speech or action
Usage: He stumbled into a new hobby when a friend invited him to a painting class.
- **Subtle** /'sʌtl/ (**adjective**): Delicate or understated; not immediately obvious
Usage: The design has a subtle charm.
- **Tumour** /'tjuːmə/ (**noun**): An abnormal growth of tissue, which may be benign or malignant
Usage: The tumour was detected during a routine check-up.

Contextual Questions

Annotate the following lines in the given pattern

- a. Identify the lesson and name the writer of the given lines.
- b. Discuss the context of the lines and appreciate them critically in about 75 words.
 1. You can't connect the dots looking forward; you can only connect them looking backward.
 2. Sometimes life hits you in the head with a brick. Don't lose faith.
 3. Your time is limited, so don't waste it living someone else's life.
 4. Stay Hungry. Stay Foolish.

Questions

Answer the following questions in about 150 words each

1. Why did Steve Jobs drop out of college, and how did it influence his future?
2. What did Steve Jobs learn from being fired from Apple, and how did it change his life?
3. What lesson about life and death does Steve Jobs convey in "You've Got to Find What You Love," and how does it relate to his advice on living a fulfilling life?

Creative Writing

Using the hints provided, write at least ten lines, expanding the ideas into complete sentences. Be creative!

Interviewing Inspiration

Idea: Imagine interviewing someone who inspires you—a famous figure, a family member, or a fictional character. Write a creative conversation exploring their journey to success. Include details about the setting to make it vivid and engaging.

- Hints**
1. What inspired you to follow your passion?
 2. Who supported you the most on your journey?
 3. Were there tough moments in your journey? How did you overcome them?
 4. What is the best piece of advice you've ever received?
 5. What advice would you give to someone who's still searching for their passion?

Classroom Activity

Read and Research

Polaroid cameras, Macintosh computers, and Google are just a few revolutionary inventions mentioned in Steve Jobs' speech, "You've Got to Find What You Love". These innovations have significantly changed the world in their respective times. But what about the inventions that transformed the 19th, 20th, and 21st centuries?

Let's dive into history and technology to explore these groundbreaking creations. You can check an encyclopedia or—let's be real—just Google it on the very smartphones in your hands (an invention worth celebrating in itself!). Below, the first two for each century are done for you. The rest is up to your curiosity!

19th Century

1. **Telephone** – Invented by Alexander Graham Bell, it revolutionized long-distance communication.
2. **Light Bulb** – Thomas Edison's creation brightened homes and workplaces across the world.
3. _____
4. _____
5. _____

20th Century

1. **Internet** – The ultimate game-changer for global information exchange and connectivity.

2. **Aeroplanes** – Opened the skies for faster travel and trade.

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

21st Century

1. **Smartphones** – Compact devices combining communication, computing, and entertainment.

2. **Artificial Intelligence (AI)** – Driving progress in fields ranging from healthcare to automation.

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

Ammu: Wow, Abhi! The speech is very inspiring! We have to figure out what we love and work hard to make it happen.

Abhi: Yes! Growth starts when we accept where we are and strive for where we want to be. But now let us go home!

They nod and step into the machine. Abhi presses the buttons, Ammu pulls the lever, and with a crackling burst of static, they disappear into the unknown.

1

Abhi: Did we make it back home? [spotting a banner] "Central Hall, Southampton. Poetry Recitation by Brian Bilston and Henry Normal." This is England!

5

Abhi: [sighing but smiling] All right, all right. You're too passionate to argue with. Let's go see what your Bilston guy is all about.

2

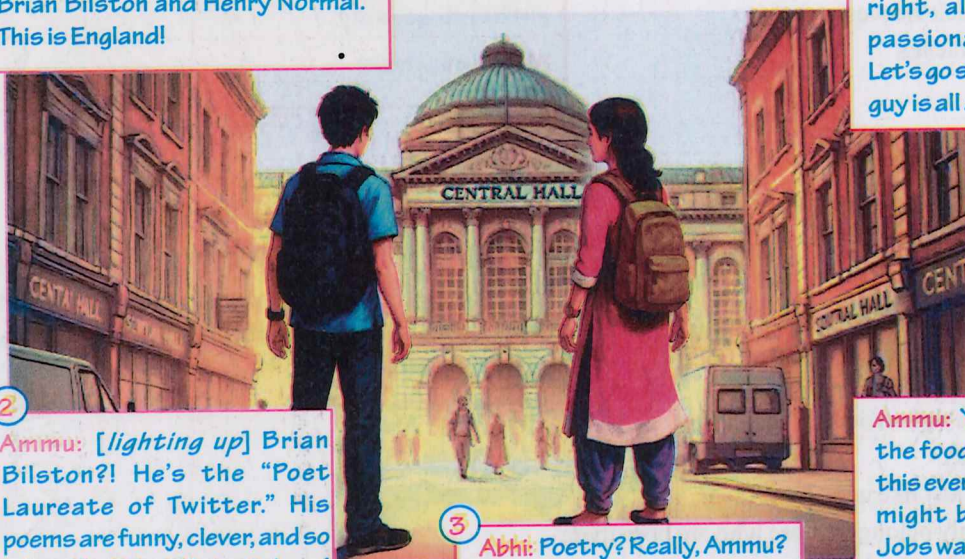
Ammu: [lighting up] Brian Bilston?! He's the "Poet Laureate of Twitter." His poems are funny, clever, and so relatable. Brian Bilston is huge!

3

Abhi: Poetry? Really, Ammu? You want to stop for poems now?

4

Ammu: Yes, Abhi! Poetry is the food of the soul. Maybe this event will inspire us. This might be the dots Steve Jobs was talking about!



They walk into the hall, with Ammu excitedly leading the way while Abhi follows, curious to see what the world of poetry has to offer.

Refugees

Brian Bilston

Poem

They have no need of our help
So do not tell me
These haggard faces could belong to you or me
Should life have dealt a different hand
We need to see them for who they really are
Chancers and scroungers
Layabouts and loungers
With bombs up their sleeves
Cut-throats and thieves
They are not
Welcome here
We should make them
Go back to where they came from
They cannot
Share our food
Share our homes
Share our countries
Instead let us
Build a wall to keep them out
It is not okay to say
These are people just like us
A place should only belong to those who are born there
Do not be so stupid to think that
The world can be looked at another way
(Now, read the poem from bottom to top!)

Pause and Ponder

Ammu: Is he your favourite poet? Look how he is talking. Look what he is saying! He is asking us to let all the refugees die!

Abhi: Ammu, wait!

Pause and Ponder

Abhi: See! In reverse! It is Brian!

Ammu: Wow! I've never read a poem like this! Just great! I feel sorry for judging fast. This is a truly great poem! I love this!

Flipping Perspectives, Finding Humanity: The Power of Turning Things Around

Did you observe how a clever flip in perspectives changed the entire meaning of the poem? Brian Bilston's brilliance lies in showing us two completely opposite viewpoints using the same words. It reminds us how powerful our thoughts and attitudes can be, turning *fear* into *understanding* and *walls* into *welcome*. By reversing the lines, the poem transforms hate into humanity, reminding us that kindness and understanding can change how we see the world.

Theme Shopping for Students

Below are the key themes and objectives to learn from Brian Bilston's "Refugees". As you understand each one, mark it off.

- Have you understood who refugees are and empathize with their struggles?
- Can you identify how the poem shows both biased opinions and compassionate views about refugees?
- Have you recognized how prejudice and fear create stereotypes about refugees?
- Have you observed how the reverse reading of the poem highlights themes of hope and solidarity?
- Can you think about our responsibility to help others and decide whether to build walls or open doors?
- Can you explore how poetry and language shape our thoughts and feelings?
- Have you understood how global issues like war, persecution, and inequality force refugees to flee their homes? Can you reflect on the importance of global solidarity in addressing these challenges?

About the Poet

Brian Bilston, born Paul Millicheap on June 14, 1970, in Birmingham, England, is a British poet and author. He is known for writing funny and easy-to-understand poems. Bilston became famous on Twitter, where he shared his clever poems that mix humour with important ideas about society.

His poems often talk about topics like who we are, social issues, and everyday life. He uses simple words to talk about big ideas in ways that make us think. Bilston's poems also play with the way they are written, encouraging readers to look at things from new angles.

Bilston has written three poetry books: *You Took the Last Bus Home* (2016), *Alexa, What Is There to Know About Love?* (2021), and *Days Like These: An Alternative Guide to the Year in 366 Poems* (2022). His first novel was *Diary of a Somebody* (2019). You can follow and engage with Brian Bilston on X (formerly Twitter) at @brian_bilston.

Summary

The poem "Refugees" is from Brian Bilston's book *You Took the Last Bus Home*. It is a powerful and moving poem that Bilston wrote after hearing about refugees drowning in the Mediterranean Sea and seeing the contrasting reactions to this tragic event on social media. The poem is his response to the widespread negative opinions about refugees and his attempt to turn those feelings of hate into something more positive.

Bilston uses a special technique in the poem to show the two very different responses he saw to the refugee crisis. The poem has two sides: one side shows the negative and prejudiced view, while the other side brings out a more compassionate and empathetic perspective. The reversed structure allows the reader to experience these contrasting views, making the poem not only about its content but also about how we can change our outlook based on perspective.

When you read the poem from top to bottom, it shows a harsh, xenophobic view of refugees. Words like "chancers," "scroungers," and "thieves" are used to describe them, portraying them as threats and burdens. This side of the poem reflects the fear and prejudice that many people have towards refugees, often seeing them as outsiders who do not deserve help. This attitude is common when people view refugees through the lens of fear or misunderstanding, believing that they are a threat to their way of life.

However, when the poem is read from bottom to top, it transforms into a message of empathy and shared humanity. The harsh words are replaced with a sense of understanding. The refugees are seen as people in need, not as threats, and the poem reminds us that they could be just like us if life had dealt a different hand. By flipping the poem, Bilston challenges us to see the refugees as individuals who deserve our help and compassion. This change in perspective is a powerful reminder of how important it is to rethink our assumptions and biases.

In a world where fear and hatred often dominate discussions about refugees, "Refugees" asks us to pause, reflect, and remember our shared humanity.

Glossary

- **Chancers** /ˈʃɑːnsə(r)z/ (noun): A person who exploits any opportunity to further their own ends
Usage: He is a hypocrite and a political chancer.
- **Haggard** /ˈhæɡəd/ (adjective): Looking exhausted and unwell, especially from fatigue, worry, or suffering
Usage: She was pale and haggard.
- **Layabouts** /ˈleɪəbəʊts/ (noun): A person who habitually does little or no work; an idler
Usage: How would you get mixed up with that layabout?
- **Loungers** /ˈlaʊndʒərz/ (noun): A person spending time lazily or in a relaxed way
Usage: The loungers on the road catcalled at him.
- **Scroungers** /ˈskraʊndʒə(r)z/ (noun): A person who borrows from or lives off others, e.g., beggars
Usage: I would like to work to prove I am not a scrounger.

Contextual Questions

Annotate the following lines in the given pattern

- a. Identify the poem and name the poet of the given lines.
- b. Discuss the context of the lines and appreciate them critically in about 75 words.
 1. So do not tell me
These haggard faces could belong to you or me.
 2. They really are
Chancers and Scroungers
Layabouts and Loungers
 3. Instead let us share our countries
Share our homes
Share our food
 4. The world can be looked at another way
Do not be so stupid to think that
A place should only belong to those who are born there.

Questions

Answer the following questions in about 150 words each

1. How does the title "Refugees" reflect the dual message of the poem?
2. Why did Brian write this poem and what effect does the poem's reversible structure has on the readers understanding of the message?

Creative Writing

Using the hints provided, write at least ten lines, expanding the ideas into complete sentences. Be creative!

Refugee's Journal Entry (One Day)

Idea: Write a journal entry from the perspective of a refugee. Imagine their struggles, hopes, and emotions as they experience a day in their uncertain journey.

- Hints**
- "Today, I woke up in a crowded shelter"
 - "We have very little food today, and I feel so weak"
 - "I can't stop thinking about my home"
 - "In this refugee camp, we are all afraid about"
 - "But, I try to stay hopeful, hoping that one day we will find a place where"

Class Room Activities

Exploring Perspectives in Poetry

1. Role-Play Debate (Empathy vs. Prejudice)

Divide the class into two groups to debate contrasting perspectives on refugees, using the two versions of the poem (*Refugees*) to support their arguments.

2. Poem Analysis (Group Work)

In small groups, analyse a section of the poem to explore its language, tone, and meaning, then share insights on how the perspectives change when read in reverse.

Ammu and Abhi sit inside the time machine, thinking about the poetry recital.

Abhi: Wow, Ammu! That was such an amazing event! Ammu... You seem emotional.

Ammu: I am thinking about the poem *Refugees*, Abhi. It's heartbreaking. I hope Brian's poem touches the hearts of many more people.

Abhi: It will, Ammu. I am sure his poems make this world a better place. Shall we see where this machine takes us next? Who knows what lesson awaits!

As Abhi starts the time machine, static fills the air and they disappear once more.

The Time Machine stops after a very long time. When the doors open, they find themselves in a dense forest. In the sky, they see huge beasts flying, and from far away, they see the heads of giant creatures towering above the trees.

Ammu shivers with fear.

Ammu: Abhi, are they...?

Abhi stares at the sky with his mouth half-open in disbelief.

Abhi: (Faintly) Dinosaurs!

They hear a huge roar behind the Time Machine, and the ground shakes like an earthquake. Abhi tries to recharge the engine quickly while Ammu looks out of the window. A dinosaur, as big as a mountain, charges toward them.

Ammu: (Loud shriek) Abhi! Run! Leave all of this! Run!

Ammu pulls Abhi out of the time machine. They hide behind a huge tree. The charging dinosaur stomps over the time machine and the machine breaks into several pieces. Ammu and Abhi fall to the ground. Ammu is crying, and Abhi has tears in his eyes. They are trembling.

Ammu: (Sobbing) Abhi! Are we going to die here?

Abhi: (Silence)

Ammu: Is there no other way to escape from here?

Abhi: There is!

Ammu: What is it, Abhi?

Abhi: We need another time machine. Someone should come here with another time machine. There is no other way.



A Sound of Thunder

Ray Bradbury

The Story

The sign on the wall seemed to quaver under a film of sliding warm water. Eckels felt his eyelids blink over his stare, and the sign burned in this momentary darkness:

TIME SAFARI, INC.

SAFARIS TO ANY YEAR IN THE PAST.

YOU NAME THE ANIMAL

WE TAKE YOU THERE.

YOU SHOOT IT.

Eckels waved a check for ten thousand dollars to the man behind the desk.

"Does this safari guarantee I come back alive?"

"We guarantee nothing," said the official, "except the dinosaurs." He turned. "This is Mr. Travis, your Safari Guide in the Past. He'll tell you what and where to shoot. If he says no shooting, no shooting. If you disobey instructions, there's a stiff penalty of another ten thousand dollars, plus possible government action, on your return."

"Unbelievable," Eckels breathed, the light of the Machine on his thin face. "A real Time Machine." He shook his head. "Makes you think, If the election had gone badly yesterday, I might be here now running away from the results. Thank God Keith won. He'll make a fine President of the United States."

"Yes," said the man behind the desk. "We're lucky. If Deutscher had gotten in, we'd have the worst kind of dictatorship. There's an anti-everything man for you, a militarist, anti-Christ, anti-human, anti-intellectual. People called us up, you know, joking but not joking.

Said if Deutscher became President they wanted to go live in 1492. Of course it's not our business to conduct Escapes, but to form Safaris. Anyway, Keith's President now. All you got to worry about is—"

"Shooting my dinosaur," Eckels finished it for him.

"A Tyrannosaurus Rex. The Tyrant Lizard, the most incredible monster in history. Sign this release. Anything happens to you, we're not responsible. Those dinosaurs are hungry."

Eckels flushed angrily. "Trying to scare me!"

"Frankly, yes. We don't want anyone going who'll panic at the first shot. Six Safari leaders were killed last year, and a dozen hunters. We're here to give you the severest thrill a real hunter ever asked for. Traveling you back sixty million years to bag the biggest game in all of Time. Your personal checks still there. Tear it up."

Mr. Eckels looked at the check. His fingers twitched.

"Good luck," said the man behind the desk. "Mr. Travis, he's all yours."

They moved silently across the room, taking their guns with them, toward the Machine, toward the silver metal and the roaring light.

First a day and then a night and then a day and then a night, then it was day night day night.

A week, a month, a year, a decade! A.D. 2055. A.D. 2019. 1999! 1957! Gone! The Machine roared.

They put on their oxygen helmets and tested the intercoms. Eckels swayed on the padded seat, his face pale, his jaw stiff. He felt the trembling in his arms and he looked down and found his hands tight on the new rifle. There were four other men in the Machine. Travis, the Safari Leader, his assistant, Lesperance, and two other hunters, Billings and Kramer. They sat looking at each other, and the years blazed around them.

"Can these guns get a dinosaur cold?" Eckels felt his mouth saying.

"If you hit them right," said Travis on the helmet radio. "Some dinosaurs have two brains, one in the head, another far down the spinal column. We stay away from those. That's stretching luck. Put your first two shots into the eyes, if you can, blind them, and go back into the brain." The Machine howled. Time was a film run backward. Suns fled and ten million moons fled after them. "Think," said Eckels.

The Machine slowed and stopped. The sun stopped in the sky. The fog that had enveloped the Machine blew away and they were in an old time, a very old time indeed, three hunters and two Safari Heads with their blue metal guns across their knees.

"Christ isn't born yet," said Travis, "The Pyramids are still in the earth, waiting to be cut out and put up. Remember that. Alexander, Caesar, Napoleon, Hitler none of them exists." The man nodded.

"That" Mr. Travis pointed "is the jungle of sixty million two thousand and fifty-five years before President Keith."

He indicated a metal path that struck off into green wilderness, over streaming swamp, among giant ferns and palms. "And that," he said, "is the Path, laid by Time Safari for your use. It floats six inches above

the earth. Doesn't touch so much as one grass blade, flower, or tree. It's an antigravity metal. Its purpose is to keep you from touching this world of the past in any way. Stay on the Path. Don't go off it. I repeat. Don't go off. For any reason! If you fall off, there's a penalty. And don't shoot any animal we don't okay."

"Why?" asked Eckels.

"We don't want to change the Future. We don't belong here in the Past. The government doesn't like us here. We have to pay big graft to keep our franchise. A Time Machine is finicky business. Not knowing it, we might kill an important animal, a small bird, a roach, a flower even, thus destroying an important link in a growing species."

"That's not clear," said Eckels. "All right," Travis continued, "say we accidentally kill one mouse here. That means all the future families of this one particular mouse are destroyed, right?"

"Right"

"And all the families of the families of the families of that one mouse! With a stamp of your foot, you annihilate the first one, then a dozen, then a thousand, a million, a billion possible mice!"

"So, they're dead," said Eckels. "So what?"



Pause and Ponder

Ammu: Oh my god! How fragile the eco-system is! That is why we should be very careful in preserving our ecology!

"So what?" Travis snorted quietly. "Well, what about the foxes that'll need those mice to survive? For want of ten mice, a fox dies. For want of ten foxes a lion starves. For want of a lion, all manner of insects, vultures, infinite billions of life forms are thrown into chaos and destruction. Eventually it all boils down to this: fifty-nine million years later, a caveman, one of a dozen on the entire world, goes hunting wild boar or sabertoothed tiger for food. But you, friend, have stepped on all the tigers in that region. By stepping on one single mouse. So, the caveman starves. And the caveman, please note, is not just any expendable man, no! He is an entire future nation. From him would have sprung ten sons. From them one hundred sons and daughters, and thus onward to a civilization. Destroy this one man, and you destroy a race, a people, an entire history of life. It is comparable to slaying some of Adam's grandchildren. The stomp of your foot, on one mouse, could start an earthquake, the effects of which could shake our earth and destinies down through Time, to their very foundations. With the death of that one caveman, a billion others yet unborn are throttled in the womb. So be careful. Stay on the Path. Never step off!"

"I see," said Eckels. "Then it wouldn't pay for us even to touch the grass?"

"Correct. Crushing certain plants could add up infinitesimally. A little error here would multiply in sixty million years, all out of proportion. Of course, maybe our theory is wrong. Maybe Time can't be changed by us. Or maybe it can be changed only in little subtle ways. A dead mouse here makes an insect imbalance there, a population disproportion later, a bad harvest further on, a depression, mass starvation, and finally, a change in

social temperament in far-flung countries. Or some subtle change occurs. Who knows? Who really can say he knows? We don't know. We're guessing. But until we do know for certain whether our messing around in Time can make a big roar or a little rustle in history, we're being careful. This Machine, this Path, your clothing and bodies, were sterilized, as you know, before the journey. We wear these oxygen helmets so we can't introduce our bacteria into an ancient atmosphere."

"How do we know which animals to shoot?"

"They're marked with red paint," said Travis. "Today, before our journey, we sent Lesperance here back with the Machine. He came to this particular era and followed certain animals."

"Studying them?"

"Right," said Lesperance. "I track them through their entire existence, noting which of them lives longest. Very few. How many times they mate. Not often. Life's short. When I find one that's going to die when a tree falls on him, or one that drowns in a tar pit, I note the exact hour, minute, and second. I shoot a paint bomb. It leaves a red patch on his side. We can't miss it. Then, we meet the Monster not more than two minutes before he would have died anyway. This way, we kill only animals with no future. You see how careful we are?" "Everyone on his feet!" said Travis sharply. They were ready to leave the Machine.

The jungle was high and the jungle was broad and the jungle was the entire world forever and forever. Sounds like music and sounds like flying tents filled the sky, and those were pterodactyls soaring with cavernous grey wings, gigantic bats of delirium and night fever.

Eckels, balanced on the narrow Path, aimed his rifle playfully.

"Stop that!" said Travis. "Don't even aim for fun, blast you! If your guns should go off"

Eckels flushed. "Where's our Tyrannosaurus?"

Lesperance checked his wristwatch. "Up ahead, in sixty seconds. Look for the red paint! Don't shoot till we give the word. Stay on the Path. Stay on the Path!"

They moved forward in the wind of morning.

"Strange," murmured Eckels. "Up ahead, sixty million years, Election Day over. Keith made President. Everyone celebrating. And here we are, a million years lost, and they don't exist. The things we worried about for months, a lifetime, not even born or thought of yet."

"Ah," said Travis.

Everyone stopped.

Travis raised his hand. "Ahead," he whispered. "In the mist. There he is. There's His Royal Majesty now."

The jungle was wide and full of twittering's, rustlings, murmurs, and sighs.

Suddenly it all ceased, as if someone had shut a door.

Silence.

A sound of thunder.

Out of the mist, one hundred yards away, came Tyrannosaurus Rex.

"It," whispered Eckels. "It...."

"Sh!"

It came on great oiled, resilient, striding legs. It towered thirty feet above half of the trees, a great evil god, folding its delicate watchmaker's claws close to its oily reptilian chest. Each lower leg was a piston, a thousand pounds of white bone, sunk in thick ropes of muscle, sheathed over in a gleam of pebbled skin like the mail of a terrible warrior. Each thigh was a ton of meat, ivory, and

steel mesh. And from the great breathing cage of the upper body those two delicate arms dangled out front, arms with hands which might pick up and examine men like toys, while the snake neck coiled. And the head itself, a ton of sculptured stone, lifted easily upon the sky. Its mouth gaped, exposing a fence of teeth like daggers. Its eyes rolled, ostrich eggs, empty of all expression save hunger. It closed its mouth in a death grin. It ran, its pelvic bones crushing aside trees and bushes, its taloned feet clawing damp earth, leaving prints six inches deep wherever it settled its weight.

"Why, why," Eckels twitched his mouth. "It could reach up and grab the moon."

"Sh!" Travis jerked angrily. "He hasn't seen us yet."

"It can't be killed," Eckels pronounced this verdict quietly, as if there could be no argument. The rifle in his hands seemed a toy gun. "We were fools to come. This is impossible."



"Shut up!" hissed Travis.

"Nightmare."

"Turn around," commanded Travis. "Walk quietly to the Machine. We'll remit half your fee."

"I didn't realize it would be this big," said Eckels. "I miscalculated, that's all. And now I want out."

"It sees us!"

"There's the red paint on its chest!"

The Tyrant Lizard raised itself. Its armored flesh glittered like a thousand green coins. The coins, crusted with slime, steamed. In the slime, tiny insects wriggled, so that the entire body seemed to twitch and undulate, even while the monster itself did not move. It exhaled. The stink of raw flesh blew down the wilderness.

"Get me out of here," said Eckels. "It was never like this before. I was always sure I'd come through alive. I had good guides, good safaris, and safety. This time, I figured wrong. This is too much for me to get hold of."

"Don't run," said Lesperance. "Turn around. Hide in the Machine."

"Yes." Eckels seemed to be numb. He looked at his feet as if trying to make them move. He gave a grunt of helplessness.

"Eckels!"

He took a few steps, blinking, shuffling.

"Not that way!"

The Monster, at the first motion, lunged forward with a terrible scream. It covered one hundred yards in six seconds. The rifles jerked up and blazed fire. A windstorm from the beast's mouth engulfed them in the stench of slime and old blood. The Monster roared, teeth glittering with sun.

The rifles cracked again, Their sound was lost in shriek and lizard thunder. The great level of the reptile's tail swung up, lashed sideways. Trees exploded in clouds of leaf and branch. The Monster twitched its jeweler's hands down to fondle at the men, to twist them in half, to crush them like berries, to cram them into its teeth and its screaming throat. Its boulderstone eyes leveled with the men. They saw themselves mirrored. They fired at the metallic eyelids and the blazing black iris, like a stone idol, like a mountain avalanche, Tyrannosaurus fell.

The men flung themselves back and away. The body hit, ten tons of cold flesh and stone. The guns fired.

The Monster lashed its armored tail, twitched its snake jaws, and lay still. A fount of blood spurted from its throat. Somewhere inside, a sac of fluids burst. Sickening gushes drenched the hunters. They stood, red and glistening.

The thunder faded.

The jungle was silent. After the avalanche, a green peace. After the nightmare, morning.

Billings and Kramer sat on the pathway and threw up. Travis and Lesperance stood with smoking rifles, cursing steadily. In the Time Machine, on his face, Eckels lay shivering. He had found his way back to the Path, climbed into the Machine.

Travis came walking, glanced at Eckels, took cotton gauze from a metal box, and returned to the others, who were sitting on the Path.

"Clean up."

They wiped the blood from their helmets. They began to curse too. The Monster lay, a hill of solid flesh. Within, you could hear the sighs and murmurs as the furthest chambers of it died, the organs malfunctioning, liquids running a final instant from pocket to sac to spleen, everything shutting off, closing up forever. It was like

standing by a wrecked locomotive or a steam shovel at quitting time, all valves being released or levered tight. Bones cracked~ the tonnage of its own flesh, off balance, dead weight, snapped the delicate forearms, caught underneath. The meat settled, quivering.

Another cracking sound. Overhead, a gigantic tree branch broke from its heavy mooring, fell. It crashed upon the dead beast with finality.

"There." Lesperance checked his watch. "Right on time. That's the giant tree that was scheduled to fall and kill this animal originally." He glanced at the two hunters. "You want the trophy picture?"

"What?"

"We can't take a trophy back to the Future. The body has to stay right here where it would have died originally, so the insects, birds, and bacteria can get at it, as they were intended to.

Everything in balance. The body stays. But we can take a picture of you standing near it."

They let themselves be led along the metal Path. They sank wearily into the Machine cushions.

Eckels sat there, shivering. "I'm sorry," he said at last.

"Get up!" cried Travis.

Eckels got up.

"Go out on that Path alone," said Travis. He had his rifle pointed, "You're not coming back in the Machine. We're leaving you here!"

Lesperance seized Travis's arm. "Wait"

"Stay out of this!" Travis shook his hand away. "This fool nearly killed us. But it isn't that so much, no. It's his shoes! Look at them! He ran off the Path. That ruins us! We'll forfeit! Thousands of dollars of insurance! We guarantee no one leaves the Path. He left it. Oh,

the fool! I'll have to report to the government. They might revoke our license to travel. Who knows what he's done to Time, to History!"

"Take it easy, all he did was kick up some dirt."

"How do we know?" cried Travis. "We don't know anything! It's all a mystery! Get out of here, Eckels!"

Eckels fumbled his shirt. "I'll pay anything. A hundred thousand dollars!"

Travis glared at Eckels' checkbook and spat. "Go out there. The Monster's next to the Path. Stick your arms up to your elbows in his mouth. Then you can come back with us."

"That's unreasonable!"

"The Monster's dead, you idiot. The bullets! The bullets can't be left behind. They don't belong in the Past~ they might change anything. Here's my knife. Dig them out!"

"You didn't have to make him do that," said Lesperance.

"Didn't I? It's too early to tell." Travis nudged the still body. "He'll live. Next time he won't go hunting game like this. Okay." He jerked his thumb wearily at Lesperance. "Switch on. Let's go home."

1492. 1776. 1812.

They cleaned their hands and faces. They changed their caking shirts and pants. Eckels was up and around again, not speaking. Travis glared at him for a full ten minutes.

"Don't look at me," cried Eckels. "I haven't done anything."

"Who can tell?"

"Just ran off the Path, that's all, a little mud on my shoes what do you want me to do get down and pray?"

"We might need it. I'm warning you, Eckels, I might kill you yet. I've got my gun ready."

"I'm innocent. I've done nothing!"

1999.2000.2055.

The Machine stopped.

"Get out," said Travis.

The room was there as they had left it. But not the same as they had left it. The same man sat behind the same desk. But the same man did not quite sit behind the same desk. Travis looked around swiftly. "Everything okay here?" he snapped.

"Fine. Welcome home!"

Travis did not relax. He seemed to be looking through the one high window.

"Okay, Eckels, get out. Don't ever come back." Eckels could not move.

"You heard me," said Travis. "What're you staring at?"

Eckels stood smelling of the air, and there was a thing to the air, a chemical taint so subtle, so slight, that only a faint cry of his subliminal senses warned him it was there. The colors, white, grey, blue, orange, in the wall, in the furniture, in the sky beyond the window, were . . . were . . . And there was a feel. His flesh twitched. His hands twitched. He stood drinking the oddness with the pores of his body. Somewhere, someone must have been screaming one of those whistles that only a dog can hear. His body screamed silence in return. Beyond this room, beyond this wall, beyond this man who was not quite the same man seated at this desk that was not quite the same desk . . . lay an entire world of streets

and people. What sort of world it was now, there was no telling. He could feel them moving there, beyond the walls, almost, like so many chess pieces blown in a dry wind . . .

But the immediate thing was the sign painted on the office wall, the same sign he had read earlier today on first entering. Somehow, the sign had changed:

TYME SEFARI INC.

SEFARIS TU ANY YEER EN THE PAST.

YU NAIM THE ANIMALL.

WEE TAEK YU THAIR.

YU SHOOT ITT.

Pause and Ponder

Abhi: Oh no! Eckles killed a butterfly! The world will change very much!

Ammu: Abhi, maybe that is why it is called as the Butterfly Effect! Even the smallest actions can impact our environment very, very much!

Eckels felt himself fall into a chair. He fumbled crazily at the thick slime on his boots. He held up a clod of dirt, trembling, "No, it can't be. Not a little thing like that. No!"

Embedded in the mud, glistening green and gold and black, was a butterfly, very beautiful and very dead.

"Not a little thing like that! Not a butterfly!" cried Eckels.

It fell to the floor, an exquisite thing, a small thing that could upset balances and knock down a line of small dominoes and then big dominoes and then gigantic dominoes, all down the years across Time. Eckels' mind whirled. "It couldn't change things. Killing one butterfly couldn't be that important! Could it?"

His face was cold. His mouth trembled, asking: "Who . . . who won the presidential election yesterday?"

The man behind the desk laughed. "You joking? You know very well. Deutscher, of course! Who else? Not that fool weakling Keith. We got an iron man now, a man with guts!" The official stopped. "What's wrong?"

Eckels moaned. He dropped to his knees. He scrabbled at the golden butterfly with shaking fingers.

"Can't we," he pleaded to the world, to himself, to the officials, to the Machine, "can't we take it back, can't we make it alive again? Can't we start over? Can't we?"

He did not move. Eyes shut, he waited, shivering. He heard Travis breathe loud in the room~ he heard Travis shift his rifle, click the safety catch, and raise the weapon.

There was a sound of thunder.

Theme Shopping for Students

Below are the key themes and objectives to learn from Ray Bradbury's "A Sound of Thunder". As you understand each one, mark it off.

- ☐ Who was Ray Bradbury, and what aspects of his life and period influenced his writing of speculative fiction?
- ☐ What is the Butterfly Effect, and how does it illustrate the idea that small actions can have significant consequences?
- ☐ How does the story explore the delicate balance of ecology and the interconnectedness of all living things?
- ☐ Can you explain the theme of responsibility and the importance of making thoughtful choices, especially when dealing with advanced technology?
- ☐ How does 'time travel' in the story represent both opportunity and danger?
- ☐ Do you understand how the author uses foreshadowing and imagery to create suspense and emphasise the fragility of the natural world?
- ☐ Can you summarise Bradbury's message about humanity's role in protecting the environment and respecting the power of nature in your own words?

About the Author



Ray Bradbury (1920–2012) was an American writer, best known for his works of science fiction, fantasy, and horror. His imaginative and thought-provoking stories often explore themes of technology, censorship, and human nature. Bradbury's writing is characterized by its poetic style, vivid imagery, and deep reflection on society's values and future. His most famous works include *Fahrenheit 451*, a dystopian novel about a future where books are banned, and *The Martian Chronicles*, a collection of short stories about humanity's colonization of Mars. Bradbury's work, including "A Sound of Thunder," often examines how small actions can have profound consequences, urging readers to think critically about their choices and their impact on the world. He remains one of the most influential writers of the 20th century.

Summary

"A Sound of Thunder" by Ray Bradbury is a science fiction short story about a man named Eckels who participates in a time-travel safari to the distant past, where hunters can kill dinosaurs. The safari is highly regulated to avoid altering the future. Hence, the participants must stay on a floating path and shoot only animals marked for death. However, when Eckels panics at the sight of a massive Tyrannosaurus rex, he stumbles off the path, accidentally crushing a butterfly.

At the end, Eckels and his fellow hunters return to the present after their ill-fated time-travelling safari. However, upon stepping back into their own time, Eckels immediately senses something is off. The air feels subtly different, and the office has an unfamiliar smell. When he glances at the sign in the time safari office, he realises that the language and spelling have changed — words appear distorted and foreign. Panic grips Eckels as he begins to understand that his actions in the past, especially his brief misstep off the path, have altered the future in profound ways.

The chilling confirmation of the change comes when Eckels learns that the presidential election result has reversed: a previously progressive candidate has lost, and a tyrannical, authoritarian figure has been elected. This shift implies a darker, more oppressive society in the altered present. When Eckels realizes the full impact of his mistake, he is overcome with horror and regret.

Travis, the safari guide, is furious with Eckels, understanding the enormity of what has happened. As punishment, he lifts his gun, and the story ends with a final 'sound of thunder.' Although Bradbury leaves the ending open to interpretation, this ominous noise strongly implies that Travis has shot Eckels whose careless action permanently changed the world. The story concludes on this note of irreversible consequence, underscoring the theme of responsibility and the potential dangers of meddling with nature and time.

Glossary

- **Annihilate** /əˈnaɪəleɪt/ (verb): to destroy; to put an end to
Usage: Nuclear bombs can annihilate whole cities.
- **Caveman** /ˈkeɪvman/ (noun): a prehistoric human who lived in caves
Usage: He played the role of caveman in my play.
- **Delirium** /dəˈlɪriəm/ (noun): a disordered state of mind or consciousness
Usage: He mumbled in delirium all night.
- **Fondle** /ˈfɒndl/ (verb): to touch or caress intimately
Usage: She fondled her puppies.
- **Expendable** /ekˈspendəb(ə)l/ (adjective): of relatively little significance, and therefore be able to be destroyed
Usage: He was a small and expendable part of the army.
- **Incredible** /ɪnˈkredəb(ə)l/ (adjective): not credible: that cannot be believed; beyond belief
Usage: I felt he made an incredible discovery.
- **Malfunction** /malˈfʌŋkʃn/ (verb): to function badly
Usage: There is a software malfunctioning in the desktop.
- **Quaver** /ˈkweɪvə/ (verb): to vibrate, tremble
Usage: He spoke in a quavering tone.
- **Remit** /rəˈmɪt/ (verb): to allow to remain unpaid
Usage: The case was remitted to the high court.
- **Resilient** /rəˈzɪliənt/ (adjective): tending to recover quickly
Usage: He is resilient and calm in nature.
- **Revoke** /rɪˈvəʊk/ (verb): to annul, repeal or to cancel
Usage: The judge revoked his driving license.
- **Sterilize** /ˈsterəlaɪz/ (verb): to render free from micro-organisms
Usage: Doctors advise people to sterilize their hands.
- **Throttle** /ˈθrɒtl/ (verb): to choke; suffocate; to kill
Usage: New Delhi is being throttled by air pollution.
- **Verdict** /ˈvɜːdɪkt/ (verb): a decision on an issue of fact in a civil or criminal case or judgement
Usage: The jury took a long time to reach its verdict.
- **Wriggle** /ˈrɪɡl/ (verb): to twist or turn the body
Usage: Children wriggled out of their wet clothes.

Essay Questions

Answer the following questions in about 300 words each

1. How does the butterfly effect influence the outcome of the story? In what ways does Eckels' single mistake demonstrate the power of small actions on the future?
2. What does the story suggest about human responsibility toward the environment and the natural world?

Creative Writing

Using the hints provided, write at least ten lines, expanding the ideas into complete sentences. Be creative!

One Day with Tomorrow's Technology

Idea: Imagine waking up one day in the future, surrounded by incredible new technologies that make life exciting, fun, and easier. Think about how your day would look with these inventions. Write a simple story about *one day of your life* with these futuristic technologies.

Hints: Gadgets – Pet robot to clean your room – A shirt that changes colour with mood – Flying backpacks to go to college – A pen that takes notes by itself – A fridge that prepares the best food – A holo-playground – At home, an A.I robot to explain tricky concepts – A pillow that tracks your dreams

Pre-Lesson Activities

Dear teacher, encourage teamwork, creativity, and critical thinking while bringing environmental consciousness and futuristic dreams to life in a collaborative classroom setting!

Activity 1: Discussion – The Butterfly Effect

Small ecological changes can lead to huge, global consequences.

1. Discussion Starter:

- The teacher explains the concept of the “butterfly effect” and provides examples, like how cutting down a single tree can impact a forest ecosystem.

2. Cause-and-Effect Chain:

- Students form groups and create a chain of events that could occur if a minor ecological change happens (e.g., removing one species from a habitat).
- Groups present their chains to the class.

Activity 2: Debate – What Inspires What?

Does sci-fi inspire technology, or does technology inspire sci-fi?

1. Divide into Two Teams:

- One team argues how sci-fi authors pave the way for new inventions.
- The other team explains how existing technology shapes the imagination of sci-fi writers.

Science without religion is lame, religion without science is blind - Albert Einstein

2. Guided Debate:

- With the teacher moderating, let each team present their arguments.
- Do your own research, and take the help of the Handbook to learn the Sci-Fi works in which writers such as Jules Verne – predicting moon landings or Ray Bradbury – foreseeing voice assistants.

Puzzle

The One Piece – The Ultimate Answer

Dear student,

One day, while exploring an old, forgotten science lab, you stumbled upon a mysterious machine. Covered in dust and adorned with intricate controls, it looked like something out of a science fiction tale. As you examined it closer, you noticed an inscription: *Temporal Adventures Inc.* Curiosity overtook caution, and you reached for a button labelled *Activate*. Was it a time machine? Could it still work? Only one way to find out! When you pressed the button, the machine hummed to life, and a low, captivating voice started to speak:

“Hello, adventurer! You’re back! I knew you’d return for The One Piece. I’m Captain Chronos, the keeper of time. Your mission is to reactivate this ancient machine. But first, you must solve three puzzles. Each will lead you to a piece of the ultimate code. Take the help of your lesson A Sound of Thunder and gather all the three codes. You’ll unlock the secrets of the ages. Here are your tests:

1. The First Piece: Crossword Puzzle
2. The Second Piece: Double Puzzle
3. The Third Piece: Hidden Message Puzzle

When you’ve collected all three pieces, they’ll come together to form the secret code. Grab the Cipher Book, decode their meanings, and reveal the final clue. Are you ready? There’s no turning back now—onward to glory!”

The Cipher Book

All the code words are derived from an ancient language, and their meanings are safeguarded in the cipher book. Beware, adventurer, for the words have the power to manifest worlds!

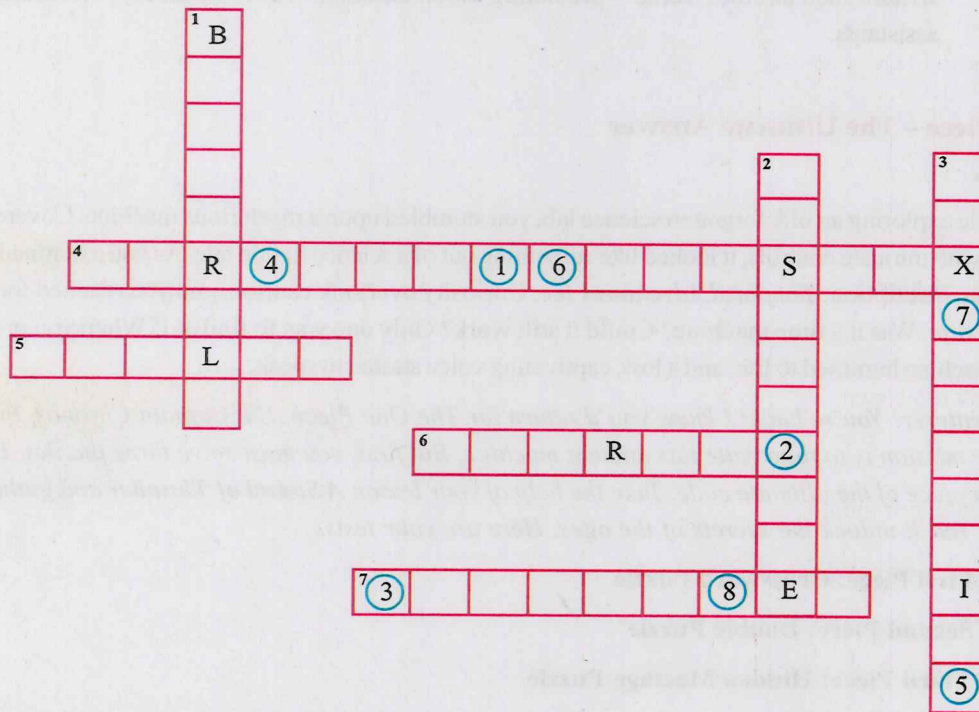
कर्तव्य (Kartavya) – Duty	संघर्ष (Sangharsha) – Struggle
सदानाथ (Sadanath) – Practice	मुक्ति (Mukti) – Liberation
सत्य (Satya) – Truth	सद्यते (Sadyathe) – Possible
सर्वम् (Sarvam) – Everything	विजय (Vijaya) – Victory
ज्ञानम् (Gyanam) – Knowledge	आनन्द (Ananda) – Joy
शान्ति (Shanti) – Peace	सदानाथ (Sadanath) – The Eternal Lord
धैर्यम् (Dhairyam) – Courage	बल (Bala) – Strength
प्रेम (Prema) – Love	योग (Yoga) – Union

Winners see the gain, losers see the pain – Shiv Khara

The First Piece

The Cryptic Crossroad

Solve the cryptic puzzle below to uncover the first word of the code.



Across

4. The name of the dinosaur that the hunters killed.
5. The name of the hunter who went out of the path.
6. The country where Ray Bradbury was born
7. The name of the presidential candidate that lost in the beginning and won in the ending.

Down

1. The insect that was killed in the past.
2. The name of the assistant of Travis, the safari leader.
3. The number of years the hunters travelled back in time.

The Code 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8

The Second Piece

Double Puzzle

Decode the following scrambled phrases to reveal the second word:

1. Het Nduso fo Dtruhne

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31	32	33	34	35	36	37	38	39	40	41	42	43	44	45	46	47	48	49	50	51	52	53	54	55	56	57	58	59	60	61	62	63	64	65	66	67	68	69	70	71	72	73	74	75	76	77	78	79	80	81	82	83	84	85	86	87	88	89	90	91	92	93	94	95	96	97	98	99	100
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2. Ftyeulr**bt** Fceeft

							4						8			
--	--	--	--	--	--	--	---	--	--	--	--	--	---	--	--	--

3. Yats no eht Ahpt

[illegible]

- #### 4. Xisty Lliomni Sryea

[illegible]

5. Ew Eegutnar Aoghnit

6. Odgo Kcul

			3				
--	--	--	---	--	--	--	--

The Code: 1 2 3 4 5 6 7 8

The Third Piece

The Hide and Seek

This is a maze of letters. Below the grid are the meanings of the words you need to find in the maze. Find all the words and cancel them in the maze. The first six of the remaining words is your code.

E	S	A	R	E	V	A	M	V	I	N	N	C	M	X
D	L	C	E	B	T	U	N	W	O	O	V	U	M	K
N	L	G	Z	W	Y	A	U	R	I	J	I	X	B	E
H	M	A	G	R	Y	Z	L	S	V	R	Q	Q	L	K
J	G	N	Q	I	C	G	S	I	I	Q	U	O	Z	W
I	E	O	A	J	R	E	O	L	H	Q	O	O	C	V
N	X	H	P	M	R	W	E	W	W	I	S	X	M	E
C	P	I	B	P	E	D	Z	E	L	D	N	O	F	R
R	E	O	E	I	K	V	L	C	Q	B	K	N	G	D
E	N	D	B	U	W	N	A	D	U	U	O	H	A	I
D	D	T	J	K	J	Q	R	C	G	U	A	B	N	C
I	A	D	E	Z	I	L	I	R	E	T	S	V	Z	T
B	B	R	E	S	I	L	I	E	N	T	I	M	E	R
L	L	L	X	U	A	M	F	K	D	Y	B	A	E	R
E	E	J	T	H	R	O	T	T	L	E	D	G	E	B

- To destroy; to put an end to: _____
- That cannot be believed: _____
- To vibrate, tremble: _____
- Of relatively little significance: _____
- A prehistoric human who lived in caves: _____
- To choke: _____
- To render free from micro-organisms: _____
- A disordered state of mind or consciousness: _____
- Tending to recover quickly: _____

10. A decision on an issue of fact: _____

11. To allow to remain unpaid: _____

12. To twist or turn the body: _____

13. To touch or caress intimately: _____

The Code: 1 2 3 4 5 6

The One Piece

Lay down your three codes here and decipher them into English using the cipher book.

The Codes

The Translation

Now, complete the One Piece using the above words.

_____ is _____ with _____

Ahoy, adventurer! At last! You have not just found the One Piece of the machine, but the One Piece of life itself! Nothing can stop you now! Keep the code at heart. Remember, those are the magical words that open every door in your life! Go on! Find more adventures!

Ammu and Abhi sneak into the back of Travis's time machine and hide there. Later, the hunting party returns, and the machine hums to life. Soon they are all back in 2055. The hunters celebrate briefly, but the mood shifts when they realize that Eckles killed a butterfly. They watch as Travis kills Eckles. They shudder with fear. They remain silent until they are all alone and then step out into a vast hall. In the hall, dozens of time machines are lined neatly in rows. Among all of them, only one glows with life, humming with energy.

Abhi: Ammu, let's go. Slowly. [pointing] Look over there! That machine is active. Maybe we can use it to go home.

Ammu: [nervously] Is it safe? Or should we wait?

Abhi: There's no other way, Ammu. Did you see Travis? He killed Eckles without a second thought. We can't wait for help. Let's go.

As they approach the active machine silently, Abhi peers through its window. His eyes widen in shock and surprise.

Abhi: [whispering] Ammu, look! That's Vinny! What is she doing here?

Inside, their friend Vinny is involved in a mysterious task, working with the controls of the active time machine. Her expression is serious, and her hands move quickly over buttons and switches.

Before Ammu and Abhi can react, a sharp sting-bullet hits Ammu's neck. Her vision blurs as she falls on the ground, asleep.

Abhi: [spinning around] Ammu!

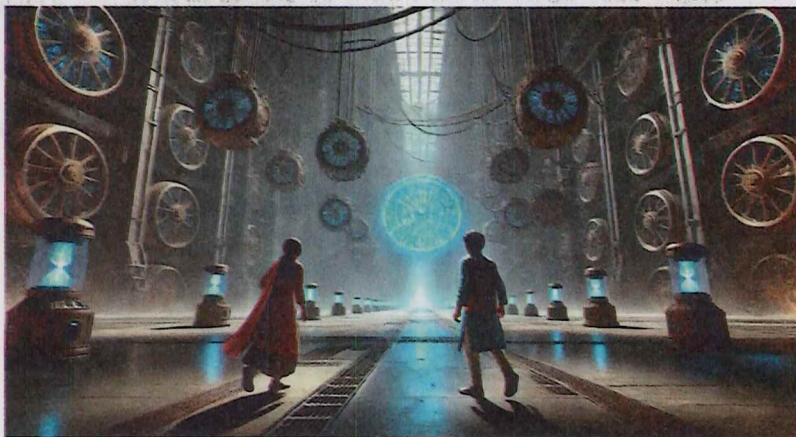
Behind them stands a figure in a long coat and hat, holding a strange, futuristic injection gun. His eyes gleam with authority and intelligence

Abhi: [terrified] Who are you?!

The man steps forward, and his face is illuminated by the light of the glowing machine.

Man: I am Ray Bradbury. Time Police and the Keeper of all Time Machines. And you two have caused quite the disturbance.

Ray Bradbury points his gun at Abhi. Abhi stares in disbelief, his heart pounding as he realizes the enormity of the situation



(To be continued...)